

2026 AUSTRALIAN JUNIOR CHESS CHAMPIONSHIP PROBLEM SOLVING U12 CANBERRA

NAME: _____

DATE OF BIRTH: _____

Please circle your age group:

- U14 (born in 2013 or after)
- U16 (born in 2011 or after)
- U18 (born in 2009 or after)

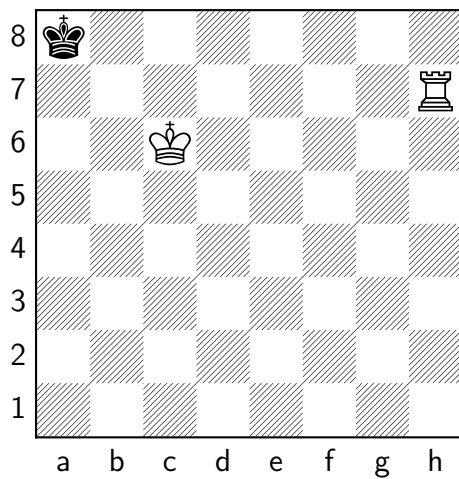
Please circle: Boy or Girl

Please read the following rules.

- You have up to 2 hours for the problem solving paper. You may not need all that time. You can leave after handing in your answers.
- The questions go from easy to hard, so it's best to start at the beginning and go in order.
- You can use your chess board and pieces to help you.
- Each page show a question and a point you can obtain. Please write your answers in the space under each picture. Altogether, the test has 100 points. Even if you don't give perfect answers, you can still get some partial points.
- For endgame puzzles, show enough moves to reach a position where you are clearly winning or drawing.
- You don't have to finish them all, do your best and solve as many puzzles as you can.

Enjoy the problem solving.

Example Q1. Mate in two.

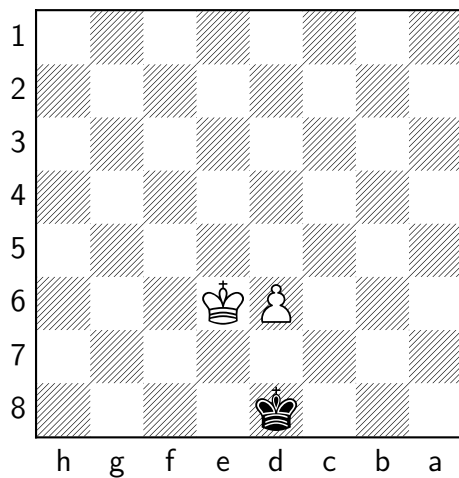


☐ The open box shows White's move.

Answer:

1. Kb6 Kb8 ← Write the first White move, then the first Black move.
2. Rh8# (1-0) ← Write the second White move, which is a mate.

Example Q2. Black moves and draws.

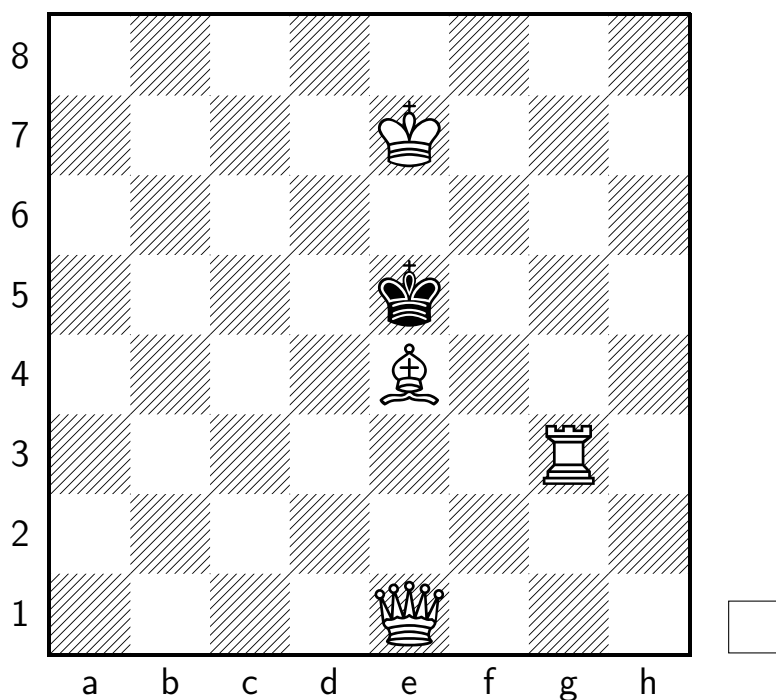


☒ The closed box shows Black's move.

Answer:

1. ... Ke8
2. d7+ Kd8
3. Kd6 (draw) ← Write enough moves showing a clear draw position.

Q1A. Mate in two. (4 marks)



Answer:

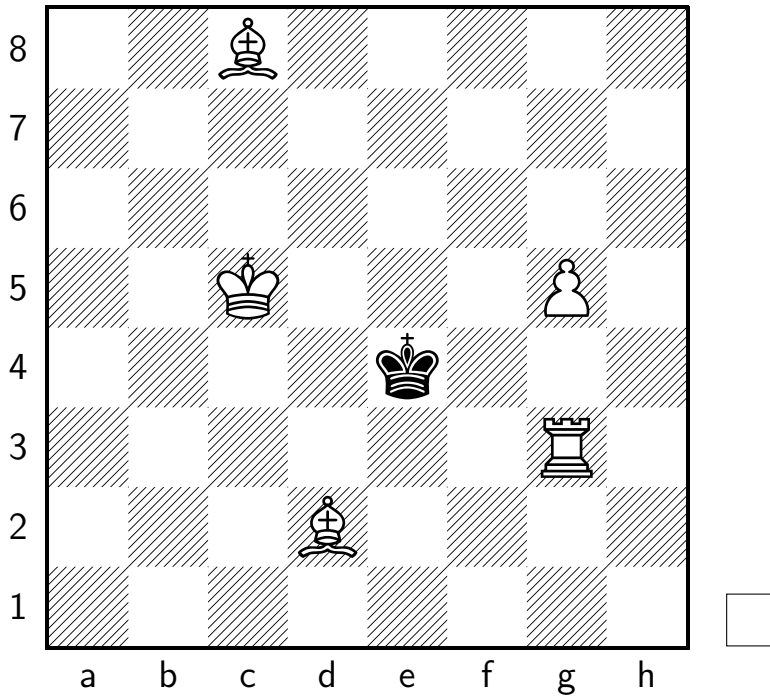
1 ♖e3! ♔f4 2 ♕g3#

1... ♕d4 2 ♗c3#

Intention: Symmetry, zugzang (Easy warm-up)

Source: Smuel Loyd, Household Journal, 1861

Q1B. Mate in two. (4 marks)



Answer:

1 ♖g2! ♔f3 2 ♗b7#

1... ♕d3 2 ♗f5#

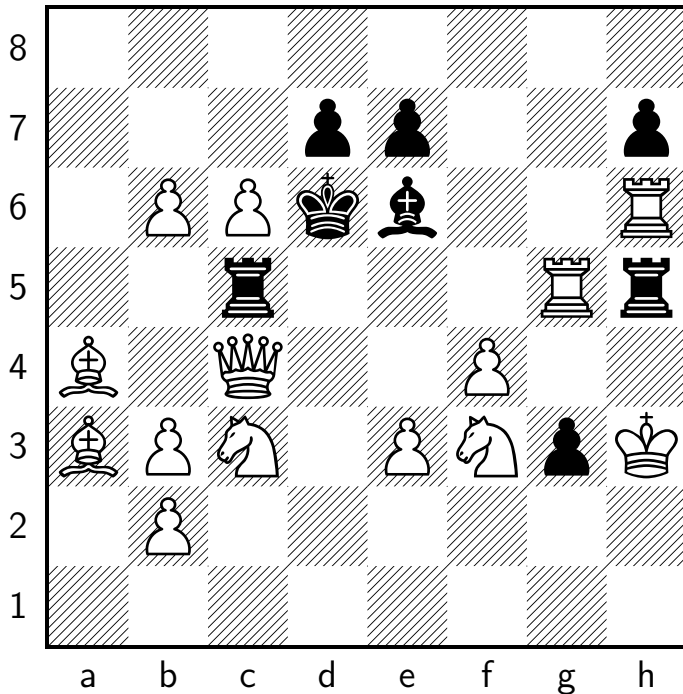
1... ♕e5 2 ♖e2#

Intention: Two bishops (Easy warm-up)

The previous one or this one for easy warm-up.

Source: Smuel Loyd, Musical World, 1859

Q5. What is the missing piece? Which turns? What is the position of the missing piece? Then, answer the last few moves.



Answer:

Article 1.2 of "Laws of Chess" says "Leaving one's own king under attack, exposing one's own king to attack and also 'capturing' the opponent's king are not allowed."

1. King can not be captured, so the one missing piece is White king.
2. Black king is in check by White Bishop. You can not leave your king under attack. Therefore, Black's move now.
3. What is the previous White's move? It is not White's Bishop move, so White King moved from b3 to c3, which creates discovery check to Black King.

This puzzle was used in 2019 Q10.

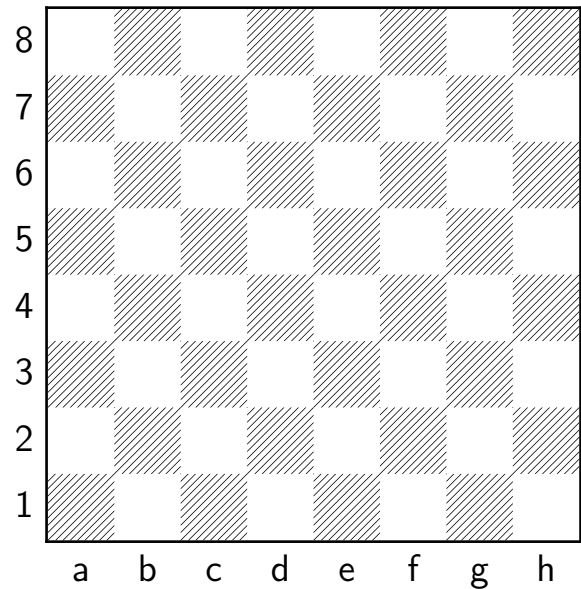
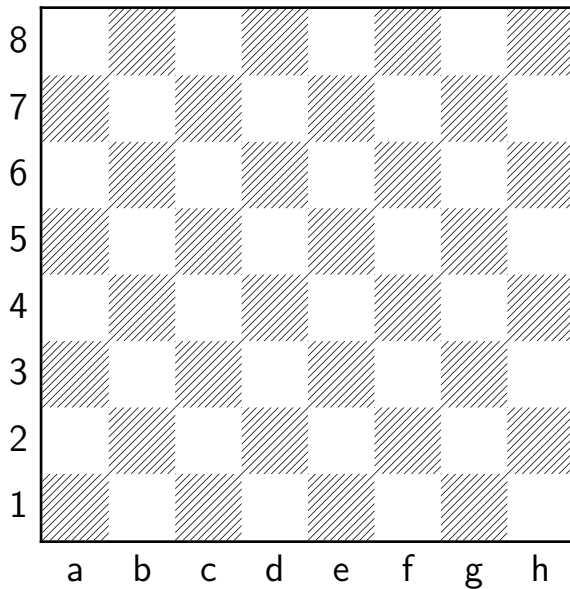
-1 h×g3 eZp+ Bd5+WXYZ)

Source: Raymond M. Smullyan: The Chess Mysteries of the Arabian Knights

2R4k/8/5N1P/8/8/8/4K3/1q6 b - - 1 4

Q14. 8 Queens Independent puzzle. Place 8 queens on the board so that all 8 Queens don't attack each other. (8 marks)

Do you know? There are 4,426,165,368 (${}_{64}C_8$) patterns to place 8 queens on the board. Among those pattern, only 92 patterns are correct. In one episode of "Take Take Take" YouTube channel, Magnus Carlsen took 8 minutes 20 seconds to complete this task. Can you beat him?

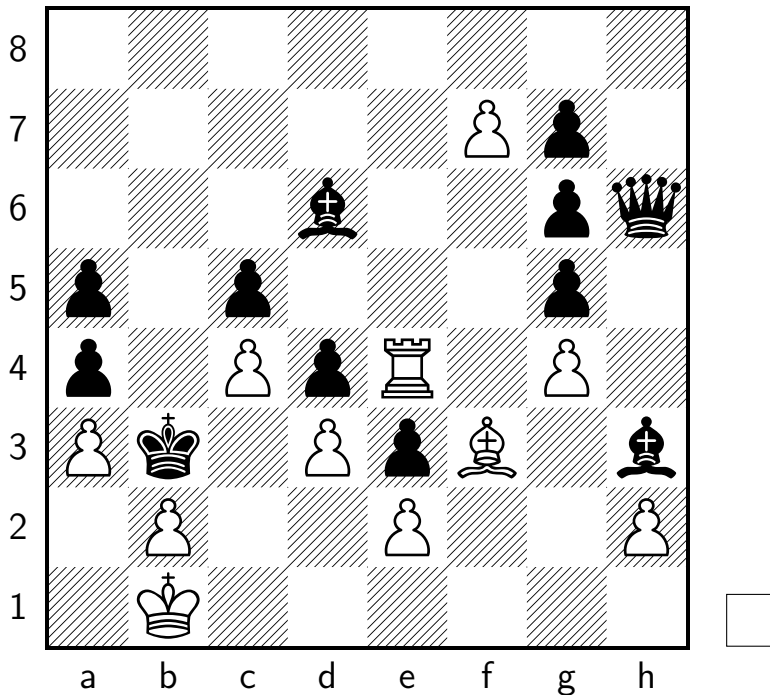


Answer:

We can not give you 8 queens, so use 8 pawns instead. Fill 8 squares in the left board with the letters "Q". When you make mistakes in the left board, write a large cross on the left board and use the right board.

Q15. Mate in six. (8 marks)

In memory of Daniel Naroditsky (1995-2025). He is an American grand master, and is a famous streamer as "Danya". He tragically passed away in October 2025 at the age of 29.



Answer:

1 ♖e7! ♙xe7 2 f8♚ ♙xf8 3 ♙c6 ♚h4 4 ♙xa4+ ♚xa4 5 ♙a2 ♚e1 6 b3#

Intention: Sacrifice for Bishop's path, block Queen's path, and setting up mate. (Hard?)

Source: "Grandmaster Solves Grandmaster-Level Puzzles" from Daniel Naroditsky's YouTube channel. The puzzle itself is puzzle ID925 of Chess.com (rating 3020 at the time).